

Our topic today is the dualist view that we are (either wholly or in part) immaterial things.

You may recall that we came up with two dualist answers to
the identity question:

A large blue circle with a white drop shadow, containing white text. The text is centered and reads: Simple dualism: I am an immaterial soul.

**Simple
dualism: I am
an immaterial
soul**

A solid blue circle with a slight drop shadow, containing white text. The text is centered and reads: "Fusion dualism: I am a combination of a soul and a body".

Fusion
dualism: I am
a combination
of a soul
and a body

**Soul
survival:**

X is me just in
case X is the
same immaterial
soul as me

Fusion survival:

X is me just in case X
has the same immaterial
soul as me and is the
same material thing as
me

For right now we're going to set aside the question of which of these views is better.

Instead, we're going to ask a more fundamental question: is there any good reason to believe in the existence of immaterial souls?

We have no
sensory
experience
of
immaterial
souls.

It is not
self-evident
that there
are
immaterial
souls.

We have no good
argument for the
existence of
immaterial
souls.

But the following principles are plausible:

If P is not self-evident
and your senses don't tell
you that P and you don't
have a good argument for P ,
you should not believe P .

Consider, for example, the belief that fairies are real. This is not a belief you should have. But why not? Arguably, not because there is some great disproof of fairies, but rather because there is no good reason to believe that they exist.

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• in the air •

experience



Wednesday 12 November 1100

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Wednesday

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